

Project Brief: Trade Axis Multi-Vendor Marketplace

Project Overview

Trade Axis was developed as a comprehensive, scalable multi-vendor e-commerce platform. It provides independent vendors with dedicated frontend dashboards to manage their own inventory, shipping, and order fulfillment, all hosted under one unified, professional brand.

The Challenge

The client initially requested a robust marketplace system that could handle multiple independent storefronts. A key requirement was achieving localized payment functionality, specifically catering to the Zimbabwean market's reliance on mobile money and local payment systems, which required custom technical implementation.

Solution & Technical Stack

To deliver a high-performance solution, the following technical stack was deployed:

- **Core:** WordPress & WooCommerce
- **Vendor Management:** Dokan Multi-Vendor Plugin
- **Frontend Development:** Elementor Pro & WoodMart Theme
- **Payment Integration:** Custom Paynow API Implementation
- **Infrastructure:** PHP backend environment

Key Feature: Custom Payment Gateway

A major technical hurdle was integrating the Paynow API to support local Zimbabwean payment methods (EcoCash, Zimswitch, InnBucks) within the WooCommerce ecosystem. This solution included automated commission splitting and a seamless checkout experience adapted for regional financial infrastructure.

Project Evolution

During the development lifecycle, the project scope expanded to include rigorous testing of payment flow integrations and a transition from a temporary development environment to a live,

production-ready gateway. The final deliverable included a fully responsive, user-centric marketplace capable of handling automated vendor payouts and local payment processing.

Final Deliverables

- Fully deployed and functional multi-vendor marketplace website.
- Configured vendor dashboards for independent store management.
- Customized Paynow API integration for live Zimbabwean payment processing.
- Responsive design implementation optimized for all devices.
- Administrative documentation for secure API management and site maintenance.

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